

Assessment	Test	Domain	Skill	Difficulty
SAT	Math	Advanced Math	Equivalent expressions	Hard

Question

The expression $(3x - 23)(19x + 6)$ is equivalent to the expression $ax^2 + bx + c$, where a , b , and c are constants. What is the value of b ?

Correct Answer: -419

Rationale

The correct answer is -419 . It's given that the expression $(3x - 23)(19x + 6)$ is equivalent to the expression $ax^2 + bx + c$, where a , b , and c are constants. Applying the distributive property to the given expression, $(3x - 23)(19x + 6)$, yields $(3x)(19x) + (3x)(6) - (23)(19x) - (23)(6)$, which can be rewritten as $57x^2 + 18x - 437x - 138$. Combining like terms yields $57x^2 - 419x - 138$. Since this expression is equivalent to $ax^2 + bx + c$, it follows that the value of b is -419 .